

insight ■ netreturns



# DREAM JOB

## Cast the World Wide Web to net the job you want

**L**ike a good hairdresser, a good job is rather hard to find and the current economic scenario has not made things any easier for the hopefuls. A scouring of the classifieds within dailies, a shuffle of pages in the employment newspapers, a frantic 'try-to-get-me-in' phone call to a friend or relative—all these are routine acts for a job seeker. And getting a job is just half the battle; with work satisfaction always an illusory goal, the search for 'something better' is never quite over.

This is where the Internet comes in—it takes your worth as an employee and grants it greater visibility. It is like moving from page 3 of a newspaper to a lighted billboard on a busy highway. So you stood within the top 10 per cent of your graduation batch? Log on to a job site and tell the world about it. If you have more than 14 years of hard-earned experience in the IT field and are in search of a better payscale, don't apply to two or three companies, go the whole mile and apply to 300 of them! Advertise yourself—sooner or later, your

credentials are bound to catch the right eye and then, who knows? So let's mouse our way through the best job sites that the Internet has to offer.

### Opening new doors

A job site aims to offer a unified portal to getting the job of your dreams. As Joy Ghosh, vice president of marketing and sales of JobsAhead puts it, "In the traditional job market, jobseekers are handicapped by lack of information on available opportunities, especially outside their geographical location. The Internet gave a huge opportunity to bridge this information gap." The Internet is akin to a bridge between the job seeker and the awaiting opportunities. Dhruv Shenoy, vice president of marketing at Monsterindia, explains further: "Traditionally, the job opportunities a person could seek were constrained by geography. A person in Delhi could access only jobs advertised in newspapers of Delhi or through placement

agencies based in Delhi. Today, a job in Shillong has access to the same job seeker in Delhi or any person, any in the world! The equation has thus changed, helping talented professionals their choice on the employer rather than the other way around."

Blurring geography is just one of the benefits of a job site. The other large benefit is the database of both companies and job seekers. One of the major recruiters that such a site accumulates is a very large database has been the golden key for many a job seeker, a fact that Rajan Jha, a computer graduate, attests to: "I was fortunate to discover an online job site as I completed my graduation. By setting a simple query, I was soon inundated with very viable and attractive offers."

Today, Parids world is a major software company—that he thanks the Internet. Shenoy explains the reason for the success of such a service via Monsterindia: "In 1994, Monster was a simple job site which listed jobseekers

**info** Roughly 20 per cent of Internet users use the Web to search for a better job